Secret Cornwall Surf Spots

What the surf-finder model found on the Newquay to Padstow and Bude coasts

October 2026

The short version

• **Most Boilers-like right:** Bude #10 *, 1.0 km from Stanbury Mouth (50.90108, -4.56406). It's a right on 330° (NNW) swell and scores 56/100 against Boilers.

• **Pentire Point vs Boilers:** 47/100. The headland and wave size are similar, but the seabed is very different. Pentire comes out as a right on NW swell.

• **Best unknown spots to check:** Trevose #14 (0.7 km from Crantock, a peak like Porthleven); Bude #14 (0.8 km from Yeol Mouth, a right like Marsland Left); Trevose #2 (0.5 km from Crantock, a left like Cribbar Point).

• The model got the left/right calls right on the known spots it could test: Boilers and Anchor Point are rights, and six Cornish reefs and points are lefts.

• Everything here is a computer model. Use it as a shortlist to check in Google Earth and in person, not a guarantee.

How to read this report

Similarity score (0-100). How alike two spots are in shape and setting: the headland, the seabed, how waves break across different swell directions, and how often the right swell and wind turn up. A high score means "built like Boilers", not "as good as Boilers". For scale, proven Cornish reefs score between 6 and 52 against Boilers.

Left / right. Which way the wave peels for a surfer riding it towards the beach. **right** = breaks to your right, like Boilers and Anchor Point. **left** = breaks to your left. **both ways** = a peak with both a left and a right.

Best swell. The direction the swell comes *from* that the model says suits the spot best, for example 300° (WNW). A star (*) after a name means a possible new spot, at least 1 km from any break in the list.

1. Rights most like Boilers

These are the candidates the model calls rights, ranked by how closely they resemble Boilers. Anchor Point, the other famous Moroccan right point, is shown for comparison. Boilers and Anchor Point score 66 against each other.

#	Spot	Where	Lat, lon	Best swell	vs Boilers	vs Anchor
1	Bude #10 *	1.0 km from Stanbury Mouth	50.90108, -4.56406	330° (NNW)	**56**	54
2	Trevose #7 (Boobies)	Boobies	50.54160, -5.03060	310° (NW)	**53**	49
3	Trevose #6 *	Pentire Point (Polzeath)	50.58519, -4.93189	320° (NW)	**49**	40
4	Trevose #12	0.8 km from Penhale	50.40276, -5.14878	330° (NNW)	**43**	39
5	Bude #14	0.8 km from Yeol Mouth	50.91276, -4.56474	300° (WNW)	**37**	33

All five want north-west swell. The top two score as high as the most Boilers-like proven Cornish reef (Treyarnon, 52).

2. Possible new spots

These candidates are at least 1 km from any break in the list. Each one is matched to the proven break it is most built like.

Spot	Lat, lon	Left / right	Best swell	Most like	Score	vs Boilers
Bude #13 *	50.75193, -4.61976	left	290° (WNW)	Tremoutha Haven	**70**	44
Bude #10 *	50.90108, -4.56406	right	330° (NNW)	Treyarnon	**67**	56
Bude #15 *	50.70799, -4.67405	left	250° (WSW)	Treyarnon	**63**	51
Trevose #8 *	50.38433, -5.15301	both ways	320° (NW)	Porthleven	**61**	53
Trevose #6 *	50.58519, -4.93189	right	320° (NW)	Millook	**60**	49
Trevose #5 *	50.50073, -5.04267	left	250° (WSW)	Treyarnon	**53**	41
Trevose #10 *	50.54781, -5.03567	left	250° (WSW)	Cribbar Point	**51**	22
Trevose #15 *	50.37838, -5.15415	left	230° (SW)	Millook	**49**	28
Trevose #11 *	50.57113, -4.99769	both ways	330° (NNW)	Cribbar Point	**46**	41

3. All 30 candidates

Ranked by how closely each one matches a proven break. Proven breaks within 1 km don't count, so a candidate sitting on a known spot can't just match itself. Spots marked "at ..." are already known breaks, which shows the model rediscovering real waves.

Spot	Where	Lat, lon	L / R	Best swell	Most like (score)	vs Boilers
Bude #11 (Black Rock)	Black Rock	50.78761, -4.56226	right	310° (NW)	Foxhole (79)	27
Bude #9	at Duckpool	50.88044, -4.56110	right	270° (W)	Compass Point (76)	35
Bude #7 (Marsland Left)	Marsland Left	50.92677, -4.55325	both ways	300° (WNW)	Treyarnon (76)	59
Trevose #14	0.7 km from Crantock	50.41233, -5.11769	both ways	300° (WNW)	Porthleven (75)	48
Bude #5	at Marsland Left	50.92241, -4.55652	left	240° (WSW)	Millook (74)	39
Bude #3 (Duckpool)	Duckpool	50.87414, -4.56145	both ways	270° (W)	Compass Point (73)	40
Bude #6 (Millook)	Millook	50.77185, -4.58386	left	250° (WSW)	Porthleven (73)	43
Bude #13 *	2.1 km from Tremoutha Haven	50.75193, -4.61976	left	290° (WNW)	Tremoutha Haven (70)	44
Bude #14	0.8 km from Yeol Mouth	50.91276, -4.56474	right	300° (WNW)	Marsland Left (69)	37
Trevose #13	at Daymer Point	50.56762, -4.92835	right	300° (WNW)	Foxhole (69)	32
Bude #1	at Tremoutha Haven	50.73439, -4.65203	right	290° (WNW)	Foxhole (69)	32
Bude #2 (Compass Point)	Compass Point	50.83191, -4.55834	right	270° (W)	Duckpool (68)	32
Trevose #7 (Boobies)	Boobies	50.54160, -5.03060	right	310° (NW)	Treyarnon (67)	53
Bude #10 *	1.0 km from Stanbury Mouth	50.90108, -4.56406	right	330° (NNW)	Treyarnon (67)	56
Trevose #9 (Constantine Reef)	Constantine Reef	50.52998, -5.02671	both ways	270° (W)	Duckpool (64)	55
Bude #4 (Stanbury Mouth)	Stanbury Mouth	50.89119, -4.56430	right	340° (NNW)	Marsland Left (63)	35
Bude #15 *	2.0 km from Pengold	50.70799, -4.67405	left	250° (WSW)	Treyarnon (63)	51
Trevose #2	0.5 km from Crantock	50.41310, -5.12476	left	270° (W)	Cribbar Point (63)	44
Trevose #1	0.7 km from Golden Burn	50.50442, -5.03775	left	230° (SW)	Treyarnon (62)	43
Trevose #3 (Treyarnon)	Treyarnon	50.52544, -5.02878	both ways	270° (W)	Duckpool (61)	49
Trevose #8 *	1.3 km from Penhale	50.38433, -5.15301	both ways	320° (NW)	Porthleven (61)	53
Trevose #6 *	Pentire Point (Polzeath)	50.58519, -4.93189	right	320° (NW)	Millook (60)	49

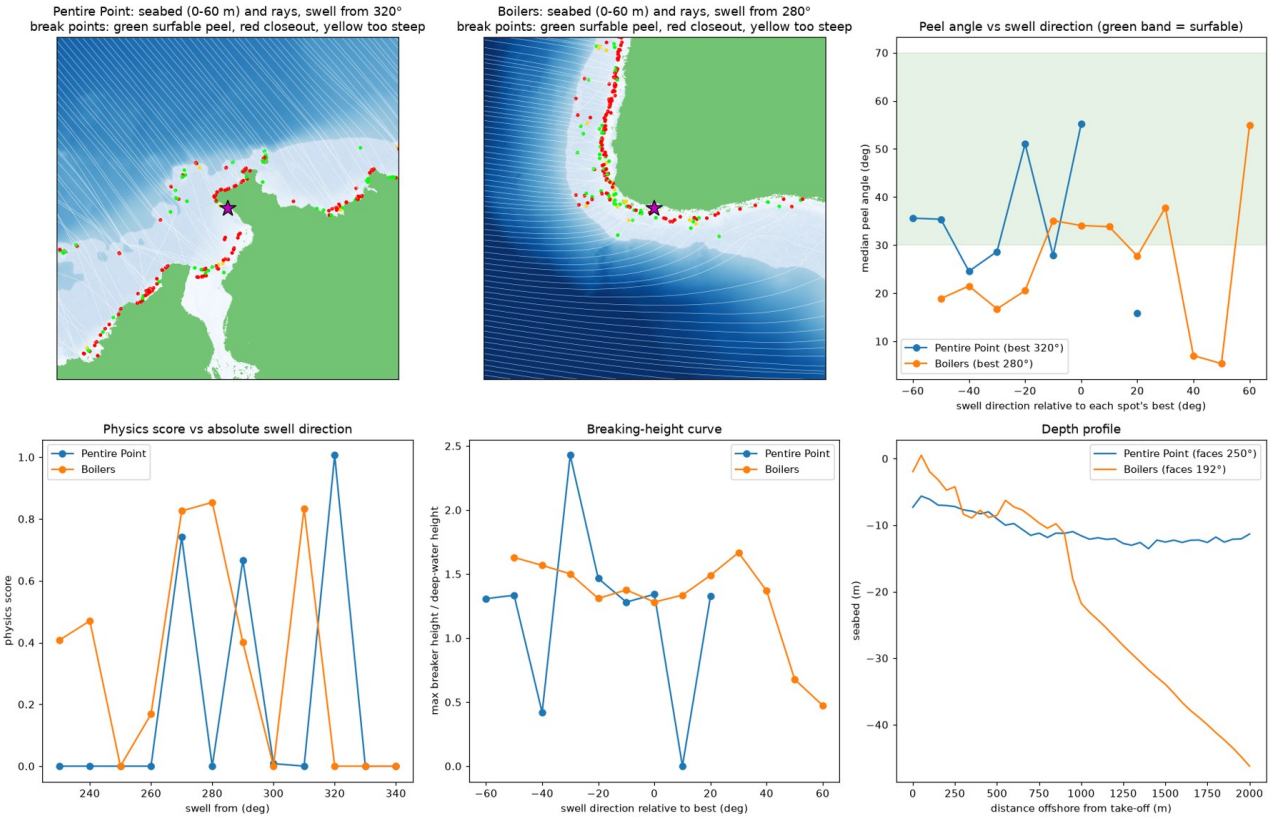
Spot	Where	Lat, lon	L / R	Best swell	Most like (score)	vs Boilers
Bude #8 (Tremoutha Haven)	Tremoutha Haven	50.73902, -4.64256	left	280° (W)	Porthleven (60)	35
Bude #12	at Tremoutha Haven	50.73999, -4.65025	left	290° (WNW)	Cribbar Point (58)	43
Trevose #12	0.8 km from Penhale	50.40276, -5.14878	right	330° (NNW)	Cribbar Point (54)	43
Trevose #5 *	1.2 km from Golden Burn	50.50073, -5.04267	left	250° (WSW)	Treyarnon (53)	41
Trevose #10 *	1.1 km from Boobies	50.54781, -5.03567	left	250° (WSW)	Cribbar Point (51)	22
Trevose #15 *	2.0 km from Penhale	50.37838, -5.15415	left	230° (SW)	Millook (49)	28
Trevose #11 *	3.0 km from Trevone	50.57113, -4.99769	both ways	330° (NNW)	Cribbar Point (46)	41
Trevose #4 (Cribbar Point)	Cribbar Point	50.42595, -5.10055	left	270° (W)	Anchor Point (43)	42

4. Pentire Point vs Boilers: 47 / 100

A detailed head-to-head, including satellite images of big-swell days. Pentire's best modelled swell is 320° (NW); Boilers' is 280° (W).

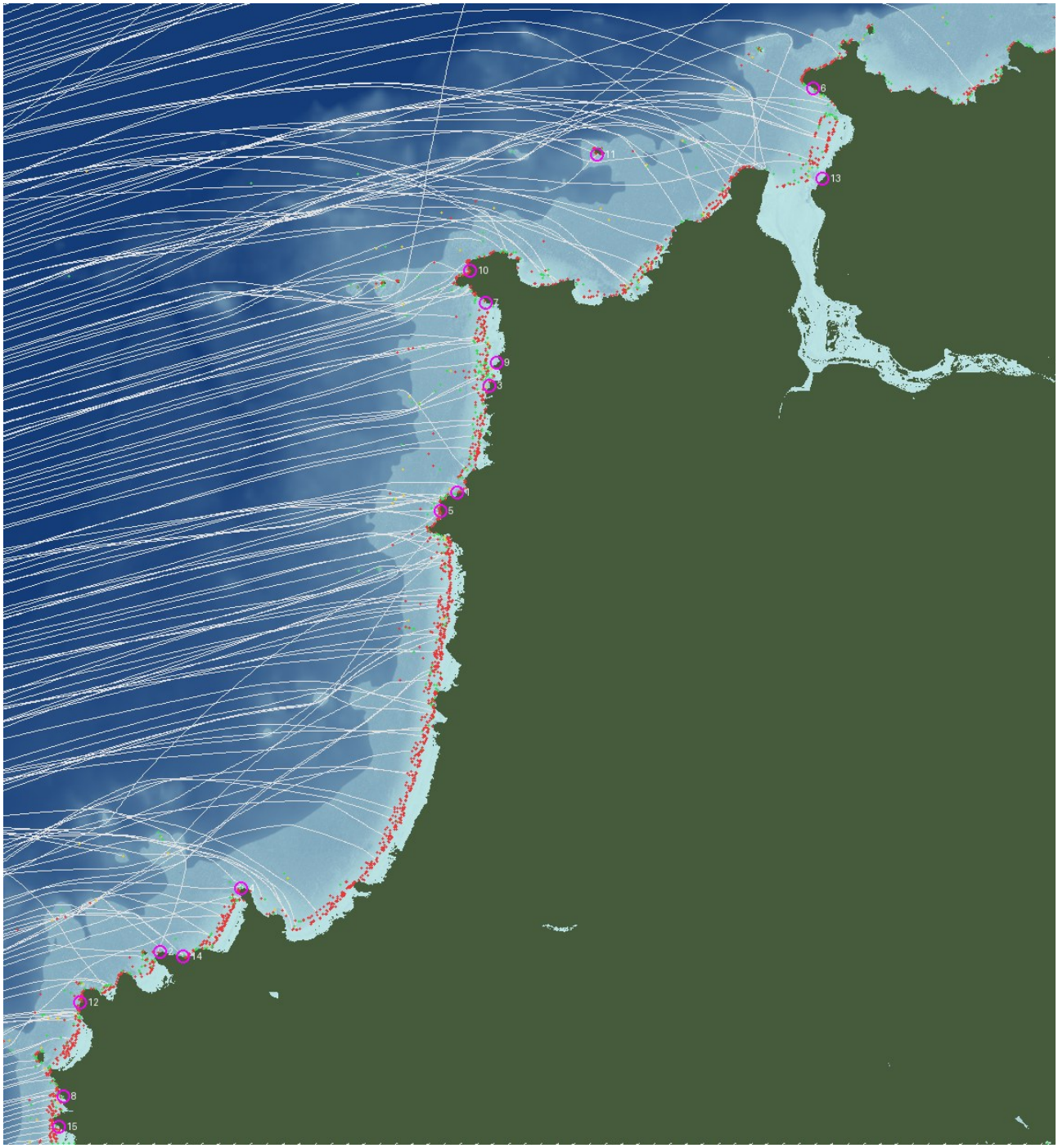
Part	Weight	Score	What it found
Headland shape	15%	**49**	Both headlands stick out about the same amount. But Boilers sits round the corner from its main swell (in the lee of Cap Ghir), while Pentire faces its swell more directly.
Seabed	20%	**26**	Both are about 9 m deep 500 m out. Then Boilers plunges to 46 m by 2 km, while Pentire stays 10-13 m deep across Padstow Bay. This is the biggest difference.
Wave physics	30%	**65**	Wave size and peel are fairly similar once lined up on each spot's best swell. Pentire peels at about 55°, Boilers at about 34°. Each works across a swell window about 30-40° wide.
Satellite images	20%	**43**	Big-swell satellite photos: waves bend more around Pentire (about 53°) than at Boilers (about 23°). There's a similar amount of whitewater at the take-off (15% vs 12%).
Swell and wind climate	15%	**47**	Pentire gets the right swell a bit more often (11% vs 7% of daylight hours), but rarely with offshore wind (2% vs 5% at Boilers).

In plain words: both headlands stick out about the same amount and make similar-sized waves. But Boilers drops into deep water within 1 km, while Pentire sits behind the shallow Padstow Bay. Boilers also wraps swell around Cap Ghir, where Pentire faces the swell more directly, and Boilers gets good wind with its swell more than twice as often.



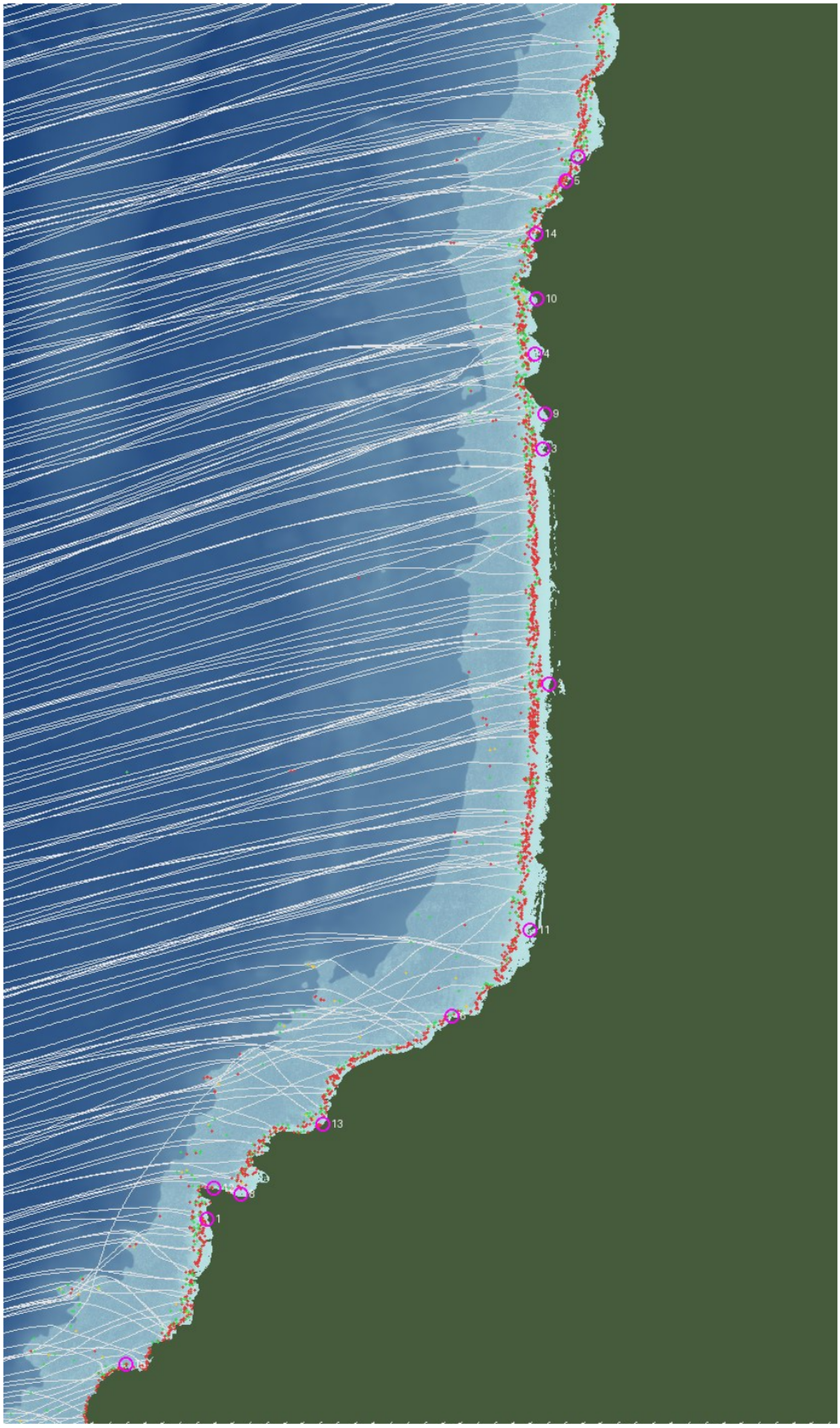
Top: the seabed (darker blue = deeper) with incoming swell lines. The purple star is the take-off point measured at each spot. Green dots are surfable peeling waves, red dots are close-outs and yellow dots are waves too steep to ride. Bottom: how peel angle, physics score, breaking height and depth change with swell direction and distance offshore.

5. Map: Newquay to Padstow (Trevose)



Purple circles with numbers are the candidates, numbered as in the tables (Trevose #1 to #15, Bude #1 to #15). White lines show swell from 250°. Coloured dots show where waves break: green = surfable peel, red = close-out, yellow = too steep.

6. Map: Bude coast



Purple circles with numbers are the candidates, numbered as in the tables (Trevose #1 to #15, Bude #1 to #15). White lines show swell from 250°. Coloured dots show where waves break: green = surfable peel, red = close-out, yellow = too steep.

7. How much to trust this

Checks that passed

• Hiding each known reef in turn, the model still ranked it in the top 2% of the Trevose coast (Cribbar 2%, Constantine 1%, Treyarnon 3%) and the top 17% of the Bude coast.

• Left/right calls: Boilers and Anchor Point came out as rights, which is correct. All six known lefts the model finds a wave at came out as lefts: Treyarnon, Millook, Tremoutha Haven, Foxhole, Marsland Left and Compass Point.

• The two Moroccan right points, Boilers and Anchor Point, are each other's closest match (66).

Limits to keep in mind

• It's a computer model of one swell (3 m at 14 s) with no tide, wind-chop or wave diffraction. Many reefs only work at one stage of the tide.

• Seabed depth near the shore comes from the colour of the sea in satellite photos. It's accurate to about 1-2 m in Cornwall, but rougher at Boilers and Porthleven.

• Daymer Point and Constantine Reef didn't show up as waves in the model, so it can miss real spots.

• "Built like Boilers" isn't "as good as Boilers". Check every spot in Google Earth on a big-swell day and in person before relying on it.

8. See the spots on a map

• **Google Earth (browser):** go to earth.google.com/web, then Projects, New project, Import KML file, and pick *candidates_matched.kml*. Red stars are rights, blue stars lefts and yellow stars peaks.

• **Google Earth Pro (desktop):** File, then Open, and pick the same file. Turn on the clock (historical imagery) to look for big-swell days.

• **Google Maps on your phone:** import the file at mymaps.google.com. It appears under You, Saved, Maps.

The file is in C:\Users\thoma\Surf Forecast\surf-finder\compare_candidates\. The spreadsheets with every score are in the same folder.